

Chapter Speakers Guidelines

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How to Get and Manage Speakers for Chapter Events

The speakers and program are the most important for chapter event success and take the most work. It also takes someone comfortable networking and who has a good network. They must also be committed. This is a fun role, but not for introverts, or those who cannot make the commitment required.

This might be called a Speaker Director, Program Chair or Education Director, it varies by Chapter.

Speaker Leads:

- Ask your peer board members
- Ask people you know, in your workplace and in your network
- CISOs, CIOs, and these roles are great speakers, who have practical experience to share and who may not regularly attend your events
- Look for people you work directly with who are cloud experts
- Local university professors who are experts
- Local attorney experts on cloud contracts, privacy law
- Local consulting organizations who practice in this area
- Certified experts or trainers in cloud security and cloud computing
- Attend other cloud events in your community and invite cloud speakers to your chapter events.
- Attend other local security events and invite cloud or relevant speakers to your chapter events
- Watch specifically for events where you might find good speaker resources to hear, meet and invite. Arrive early and sit up front so you have a chance to meet them early—they will leave after they speak often, or their time will be taken up with other clamoring audience members.
- Look at local or close-by cloud vendors and invite them speak—often they are more dependable and will sometimes travel to your location on their own expense
- Invite sponsors to speak for a fee (for sure they will expect this to be a sales pitch—proceed with caution)
- Search in LinkedIn on your 1st and 2nd level contacts for “Cloud” or “Cloud Security”, check profiles and invite those individuals (you need not be connected directly)
- Issue a call for speakers at events you attend, in surveys at your chapter events, vocally at your chapter events, and ask to make a call for speakers at other relevant events:

If you do this from a social media site, example:

Call for Speakers/Panelists for CSA Southwest Chapter for 2018 events (or be specific) for Cloud and Cloud Security thought leadership. The event attracts up to 50 attendees of mid to senior security professionals. Contact us at <Name, Email, Phone>. Make it short but specific to your event)

Tracking Your Speakers

Keep speaker leads in a matrix somewhere so you don't lose track of who you asked, who you confirmed, and who you want to invite. Include their name, company, title, and contact data—email and phones and backup, and a referral name if that's how they came to you.

If you have all vendor speakers, you will lose your audience—when they speak, and over time, because some just cannot or will not control the sales pitch. Aim for a balance and manage your speakers!

Plan for backup in case of cancellations. The better your communication and reminders to your speaker(s), the less likely this is to happen. (But it *will* happen)

Speaker Guidelines

Communicate these to your speakers:

Must be vendor neutral leading edge presentation that a security audience would want to hear. No vendor pitches! Be very clear to the speakers, especially if they are a service provider. They can brand their slides but not talk about their company's products or services, nor should their presentation be about that topic.

Speaker Confirmation

- Send confirmations
- Give them your contact details and mobile and be sure you have theirs
- Send your Agenda with meeting details
- Send reminders
- Confirm how you will receive their presentation and how it will be projected onsite
- Confirm if the presentation can be shared afterward and their preference on how

Invite them to your member list so they receive event notices now and in the future. Inform them and ask the membership director to add them with permission—make it clear they can remove themselves at any time.

Encourage them to share the presentation to their colleagues and on their social media—make it easy for them to do that.

Confirmation to your speakers include

- Confirm that they are speaking, to who, what, when, why, where and how. Be clear and complete.
- Ask them the topic they are speaking on, for a title you can use for their talk
- Give them a copy of the agenda and your chapter event url
- Inform them how they will present and how you want to receive their presentation:
- Send it to you ahead of time in what format?
- Bring it on a USB to plug in (do you have a platform ready to plug it to?)
- Bring their laptop preloaded with their presentation and connect their laptop –be sure your platform is ready for this, including possible adapters

Create a script you can easily modify for any speaker or event:

Script in a word doc that you use as a source (cut and paste), or as a canned email signature that you modify by person and event (easiest depending on your email capability)

Register your speakers for the event

They should not be expected to self-register! This is your job for the speaker board role.

Send speaker name and email ahead of time to your membership director so that each speaker is included in future event announcements. Copy the speaker, so they know you are doing this, and why.

Thank your speakers after the event concludes

This can be scripted also, as a word doc that you use as a source, or in a canned email signature that you modify by person and event.

Ask your speaker(s) if they would like you to refer them to other local groups or events for speaking opportunities (and follow-up if they say yes).

Board Role: Add Speakers to Event Agenda

1. Collect your speakers' data into a single document for the chapter event agenda

Speaker Name, title, company, the speaking topic/title they will use, and a very short bio or a URL for their LinkedIn profile. Ask for a headshot only if you use these. With permission you can take these from LinkedIn, if they exist. Additional information can be collected if needed.

2. Create a draft agenda for your chapter's event as a one-page .doc "flyer"

Create a template you use for all events and modify it for each one

- Add the chapter logo and online site presence URL (web site, LinkedIn, Facebook, ...)
- List the Date, Time, Location, Benefits, what it costs, why they should attend, and how to register
- Add the speakers, however many you use depending on frequency and length of your chapter event(s), the title of their talk, and their public profile URL from LinkedIn

- Add the sponsors by logo—get those from the sponsorship director (who should have already sent them to you)
3. **Send the “Draft Agenda” to your chapter board person** who manages the event notices and who sends them to members.
 - Ask them to add a registration URL to the event (often Eventbrite and the membership person manages the site).
 - Make the subject line clear in your email
 - Copy your entire board so they all have the same information at once, and so they can take what they need for their own roles
 - Copy the speakers
 4. **Create a script for your speakers and sponsors** to post to their social media and to send out their own invitations to attend the event. Send it to them and ask them to share it out.

NEXT:

This is part of event management, but the speaker role is often the interface.

POSTING EVENT AND SENDING ANNOUNCEMENT TO SUBSCRIBED MEMBERS

The chapter person who communicates with your members and invites them to events now adds the URL, and posts the event and sends out invitations to your members.

This individual also sends the announcement with the URL to the individuals on your board who manage other platforms your chapter uses: Administrators for your LinkedIn group, website, Facebook, Meetup or other social media where you manage your chapter business and events. Copy it to other locations outside of your chapter.

ANNOUNCING EVENT TO OTHER LOCAL GROUPS

Provide the announcement to other like groups and partners who will invite their own members, through their websites, LinkedIn groups, at in-person events, etc. This is done with permission and through advance relationships.

CPE CERTIFICATES

Someone on your board will need to create a CPE certificate for the meeting by date, time, location, chapter logo, # of CPE hours and have it signed and printed for events. A template is available from the CSA website: <https://cloudsecurityalliance.org/chapters/artifacts>.